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39 RECIPES + 3 FUNDAMENTALS LESSONS

No-Bake Desserts & Chilled Cakes

39 Recipes for Cheesecakes, Icebox Cakes, and Chilled Desserts — No Oven Required

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No-Bake Desserts & Chilled Cakes

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This book is sold for personal use. Recipes are provided for home baking; please check your own equipment, ingredient brands, and altitude, as results can vary. These recipes are based on standard no-bake and pastry ratios, not on documented testing of every recipe in this book. No recipe in this book requires an oven — oven temperatures are intentionally omitted throughout. Follow each recipe's exact chilling or setting time; no-bake desserts firm up through cold and time, not heat.

Always check ingredient labels for allergens before serving to guests.

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PART 1

Fundamentals

Three lessons on how no-bake desserts actually set, food safety without an oven, and building clean, distinct layers.

How No-Bake Desserts Actually Set

Without an oven, a no-bake dessert has to firm up through one of three mechanisms: whipped cream or whipped egg whites holding air that stiffens as it chills, gelatin forming a set gel as it cools, or simply chilling a high-fat mixture (like chocolate and butter) until it hardens.

Whipped-cream-set desserts (most of this book's cheesecakes and layered desserts) need full, cold chilling time — usually 4-6 hours minimum, often overnight — and will never set at room temperature the way a baked custard does.

Gelatin needs to be bloomed (softened in cold liquid) before it's melted into a warm mixture, and then given time to fully set in the refrigerator, usually several hours. Rushing either step gives a dessert that never firms up properly.

- Whipped cream/egg whites: set by trapped air plus cold, not heat
- Gelatin: bloom in cold liquid first, then melt in, then chill to set
- High-fat mixtures (chocolate, butter): set simply by chilling until hard
- No-bake desserts need real chilling time — there is no oven shortcut

Food Safety for No-Bake and Chilled Desserts

Because nothing here reaches a baking temperature that kills bacteria, ingredients that can carry it — raw eggs, unpasteurized dairy — need extra care. This book uses only pasteurized eggs or egg products where a recipe calls for uncooked egg, and standard pasteurized dairy throughout.

No-bake desserts with dairy or egg components must be refrigerated promptly after assembly and kept cold until served — they are not shelf-stable the way a fully baked cake is.

Most recipes in this book have a 'best within' storage window that is shorter than a baked dessert's, since there's no baking step to extend shelf life. Follow the storage time given rather than assuming a no-bake dessert keeps as long as a baked one.

- Use pasteurized eggs or egg products if a recipe calls for uncooked egg
- Refrigerate promptly after assembly — these desserts are not shelf-stable
- No-bake storage windows are shorter than baked desserts' — follow each recipe's guidance
- Keep served portions cold, especially outdoors or at a buffet

Building Clean Layers in a Chilled Dessert

Chill each layer briefly before adding the next wherever a recipe calls for it — pouring a soft layer onto an unset one causes them to blend together instead of staying distinct when sliced.

Use a clear glass dish or individual glasses for layered desserts where you want the layers to show — it also makes it easy to check that a layer has actually set before adding the next.

For the cleanest slices from a refrigerator cake or chilled cheesecake, dip a sharp knife in hot water and wipe it dry between each cut.

- Chill each layer before adding the next so they stay distinct
- Use clear glass to see layers and check they've set
- A hot, dry-wiped knife gives the cleanest slices through chilled layers

PART 2

No-Bake Cheesecakes

Ten no-bake cheesecakes, set entirely by chilling, from a classic vanilla base to a two-layer chocolate peanut butter version.

Classic No-Bake Vanilla Cheesecake

The benchmark no-bake cheesecake this book's other versions build on, set entirely by chilling.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust mixture into the bottom of the pan and chill while you make the filling.
2. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks in a separate bowl, then fold into the cream cheese mixture in two additions.
4. Spread over the crust and smooth the top.
5. Refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight until fully set before slicing.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Salted Caramel Cheesecake

The vanilla no-bake base swirled with salted caramel sauce.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold
- 1/2 cup prepared salted caramel sauce, plus more for topping

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, fold into the cream cheese mixture, then swirl in the caramel sauce gently (don't overmix, for a marbled look).
4. Spread over the crust and refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.
5. Drizzle with more caramel sauce before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Lemon Cheesecake

Bright with fresh lemon juice and zest, a lighter contrast to the richer flavors nearby.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- Zest of 2 lemons
- 1/3 cup (80ml) fresh lemon juice
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, lemon zest, and lemon juice until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the lemon mixture in two additions.
4. Spread over the crust and refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake White Chocolate Raspberry Cheesecake

Melted white chocolate folded into the base, swirled with a tart raspberry sauce.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 8 oz (225g) white chocolate, melted and cooled
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

RASPBERRY SWIRL

- 1 cup (125g) raspberries
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tsp cornstarch mixed with 1 tsp water

METHOD

1. Cook the raspberry swirl ingredients over medium heat until thickened, about 5 minutes, then cool completely.
2. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
3. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth, then beat in the cooled white chocolate.
4. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the mixture.
5. Spread two-thirds into the crust, dot with raspberry sauce and swirl, then add the remaining filling and swirl the top.
6. Refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Pumpkin Cheesecake

A spiced, fall-flavored no-bake cheesecake built on real pumpkin puree.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon

FILLING

- 16 oz (450g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 1 cup (240g) pumpkin puree
- 1 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 1/4 tsp ground cloves
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth, then beat in the pumpkin puree and spices.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the pumpkin mixture.
4. Spread over the crust and refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Chocolate Peanut Butter Cheesecake

Two layers — chocolate and peanut butter — chilled separately for a clean division.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) chocolate cookie crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

PEANUT BUTTER LAYER

- 12 oz (340g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/2 cup (130g) creamy peanut butter
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 3/4 cup (180ml) heavy cream, cold

CHOCOLATE LAYER

- 12 oz (340g) cream cheese, softened
- 4 oz (113g) semisweet chocolate, melted and cooled
- 1/3 cup (40g) powdered sugar
- 3/4 cup (180ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the peanut butter layer's cream cheese, peanut butter, and powdered sugar until smooth. Whip half the cold cream separately and fold in. Spread over the crust and chill 30 minutes.
3. Make the chocolate layer the same way, folding in the cooled melted chocolate and the remaining whipped cream.
4. Spread the chocolate layer over the chilled peanut butter layer.
5. Refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and peanuts.

No-Bake Eggnog Cheesecake

A holiday-flavored no-bake cheesecake built on real eggnog.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 1/2 cup (120ml) prepared eggnog
- 1/2 tsp ground nutmeg
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, eggnog, and nutmeg until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the mixture.
4. Spread over the crust and refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.
5. Dust with more nutmeg before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Mini Cheesecake Trifle Cups

A layered, individual-portion take on the classic no-bake cheesecake, no springform pan needed.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 8 SMALL GLASSES • 8 INDIVIDUAL SERVINGS

CRUMB LAYER

- 1 1/4 cups (125g) graham cracker crumbs
- 4 tbsp (55g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 16 oz (450g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, cold

TOPPING

- 1 1/2 cups mixed fresh berries

METHOD

1. Mix the crumbs and melted butter, divide among the glasses.
2. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, fold into the cream cheese mixture.
4. Pipe or spoon over the crumb layer in each glass.
5. Chill at least 3 hours, then top with fresh berries just before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Mocha Cheesecake

Espresso and chocolate folded into the no-bake base for a coffeehouse-style flavor.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9-INCH SPRINGFORM PAN • 12 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) chocolate cookie crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 24 oz (680g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 4 oz (113g) semisweet chocolate, melted and cooled
- 2 tbsp espresso powder dissolved in 1 tbsp hot water, cooled
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth, then beat in the cooled melted chocolate and the dissolved espresso.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the mixture in two additions.
4. Spread over the crust and refrigerate at least 6 hours or overnight.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Raspberry Swirl Cheesecake Cups

An individual-portion no-bake cheesecake with a raspberry sauce layered rather than swirled.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 8 SMALL JARS OR CUPS • 8 INDIVIDUAL SERVINGS

CRUMB LAYER

- 1 1/4 cups (125g) graham cracker crumbs
- 4 tbsp (55g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 16 oz (450g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, cold

RASPBERRY LAYER

- 1 cup (125g) raspberries
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tsp cornstarch mixed with 1 tsp water

METHOD

1. Cook the raspberry layer ingredients over medium heat until thickened, about 5 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Mix the crumbs and melted butter, divide among the cups.
3. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
4. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, fold into the cream cheese mixture, and spoon over the crumbs.
5. Top each cup with a spoonful of raspberry sauce.
6. Chill at least 3 hours before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

PART 3

Chilled Layered Desserts & Refrigerator Cakes

Eight icebox cakes and layered chilled desserts, including classic tiramisu.

Classic Icebox Cake

Layers of chocolate wafer cookies and whipped cream, chilled until the cookies soften into a cake-like texture.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X9-INCH PAN OR LOAF PAN • 12 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, cold
- 1/3 cup (40g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 boxes (9 oz/255g each) chocolate wafer cookies

METHOD

1. Whip the cold cream, powdered sugar, and vanilla to stiff peaks.
2. Spread a thin layer of whipped cream in the bottom of the pan.
3. Layer cookies flat, then a layer of whipped cream, repeating until the pan is full, finishing with a cream layer.
4. Cover and chill at least 6 hours or overnight, until the cookies have softened to a cake-like texture.
5. Slice on a diagonal to show the layered pattern.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Banana Pudding Icebox Cake

Layers of vanilla wafers, banana slices, and pudding-lightened whipped cream.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X13-INCH DISH • 12 SERVINGS

- 2 cups prepared vanilla pudding (homemade or store-bought)
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, whipped to soft peaks
- 3 boxes (11 oz/310g each) vanilla wafer cookies
- 6 bananas, sliced

METHOD

1. Fold half the whipped cream into the pudding to lighten it.
2. Layer wafers, banana slices, and the pudding mixture in the dish, repeating until full, finishing with a layer of the remaining whipped cream.
3. Chill at least 4 hours or overnight, until the wafers have softened.
4. Garnish with a few crushed wafers before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 2 days (bananas darken quickly).

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Tiramisu

Coffee-soaked ladyfingers layered with a mascarpone cream, dusted with cocoa.

PREP 30 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X9-INCH DISH • 12 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (480ml) strong brewed coffee, cooled
- 2 tbsp coffee liqueur (optional)
- 24 ladyfinger cookies
- 16 oz (450g) mascarpone, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold
- 2 tbsp cocoa powder, for dusting

METHOD

1. Mix the cooled coffee with the liqueur if using.
2. Whip the cold cream and powdered sugar to stiff peaks, then gently fold in the mascarpone until smooth.
3. Quickly dip each ladyfinger in the coffee mixture, just long enough to moisten, and arrange a layer in the dish.
4. Spread half the mascarpone cream over the ladyfingers. Repeat with a second layer of dipped ladyfingers and the remaining cream.
5. Chill at least 4 hours or overnight, then dust generously with cocoa before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy; contains alcohol if using liqueur.

Eclair Icebox Cake

Graham crackers layered with vanilla pudding and topped with a chocolate glaze, in the style of a classic eclair.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X13-INCH DISH • 14 SERVINGS

LAYERS

- 2 boxes (14.4 oz/410g each) graham crackers
- 2 batches (3.4 oz/96g boxes) instant vanilla pudding, prepared per package with milk
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, whipped to stiff peaks

GLAZE

- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 1/4 cup (25g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter, melted
- 3-4 tbsp milk

METHOD

1. Fold the whipped cream into the prepared pudding.
2. Layer graham crackers in the dish, then a third of the pudding mixture; repeat twice more, finishing with a layer of graham crackers.
3. Whisk the glaze ingredients together until smooth and pourable, then spread over the top layer.
4. Chill at least 6 hours or overnight, until the crackers have softened.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Strawberry Shortcake Icebox Cake

Sliced pound cake or ladyfingers layered with strawberries and whipped cream.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X9-INCH PAN • 12 SERVINGS

- 1 store-bought or homemade pound cake, sliced thin
- 4 cups (600g) strawberries, sliced
- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, cold
- 1/3 cup (40g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Toss the sliced strawberries with granulated sugar and let sit 15 minutes to release their juices.
2. Whip the cold cream, powdered sugar, and vanilla to stiff peaks.
3. Layer the pound cake slices, macerated strawberries with their juice, and whipped cream in the pan, repeating until full, finishing with cream.
4. Chill at least 6 hours or overnight, until the cake has absorbed the juices and softened slightly.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 2 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Chocolate Lasagna (No-Bake)

A three-layer chilled dessert — cookie crust, cream cheese layer, and chocolate pudding layer — named for its lasagna-like cross-section.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X13-INCH DISH • 14 SERVINGS

CRUST

- 36 chocolate sandwich cookies, crushed
- 6 tbsp (85g) unsalted butter, melted

CREAM LAYER

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, divided, whipped to stiff peaks

PUDDING LAYER

- 2 batches (3.9 oz/113g boxes) instant chocolate pudding, prepared per package with milk

METHOD

1. Mix the crust ingredients and press into the dish.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth, then fold in half the whipped cream. Spread over the crust.
3. Spread the prepared chocolate pudding over the cream cheese layer.
4. Top with the remaining whipped cream.
5. Chill at least 4 hours or overnight before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Peanut Butter Icebox Cake

Layers of chocolate wafers and a whipped peanut butter cream.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 6 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 9X9-INCH PAN • 12 SERVINGS

- 2 boxes (9 oz/255g each) chocolate wafer cookies
- 1 cup (260g) creamy peanut butter
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks in one bowl.
2. Beat the peanut butter and powdered sugar in another bowl until smooth, then fold in the whipped cream.
3. Layer the wafers and peanut butter cream in the pan, repeating until full, finishing with cream.
4. Chill at least 6 hours or overnight, until the cookies have softened.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and peanuts.

Key Lime Icebox Pie Cups

A no-bake, individual-portion take on key lime pie, layered rather than baked.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 6 SMALL GLASSES • 6 INDIVIDUAL SERVINGS

- 1 1/4 cups (125g) graham cracker crumbs
- 4 tbsp (55g) unsalted butter, melted
- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1/2 cup (120ml) fresh key lime or lime juice
- Zest of 2 limes
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, whipped to stiff peaks

METHOD

1. Mix the graham crumbs and melted butter, divide among the glasses.
2. Whisk the condensed milk, lime juice, and zest together until thickened slightly.
3. Fold in half the whipped cream, then divide among the glasses over the crumbs.
4. Top with the remaining whipped cream.
5. Chill at least 3 hours before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

PART 4

Chocolate & Biscuit Desserts

Seven chocolate-forward no-bake desserts, from a chilled chocolate pie to classic truffles and bark.

Classic No-Bake Chocolate Pie

A chilled chocolate mousse-style filling in a cookie crust, no oven required at all.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 9-INCH PIE PAN • 8 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) chocolate cookie crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 8 oz (225g) semisweet chocolate, melted and cooled
- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth, then beat in the cooled melted chocolate.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the chocolate mixture in two additions.
4. Spread into the crust and chill at least 4 hours, until set.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake Chocolate Oat Clusters

A stovetop cooked chocolate-peanut butter mixture set over oats — the classic no-bake cookie.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 30 MIN • BAKING SHEET (FOR SETTING, NOT BAKING) • 20 CLUSTERS

- 2 cups (200g) old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter
- 2 cups (400g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (120ml) whole milk
- 1/4 cup (25g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 cup (130g) creamy peanut butter
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Measure the oats into a large bowl.
2. In a saucepan, melt the butter with the sugar, milk, and cocoa powder, bring to a full boil, and boil exactly 1 minute, stirring constantly.
3. Remove from heat and stir in the peanut butter and vanilla until smooth.
4. Pour over the oats and stir until evenly coated.
5. Drop spoonfuls onto parchment paper and let set at room temperature or in the fridge, about 30 minutes, until firm.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains dairy and peanuts.

Classic Chocolate Truffles

A simple ganache rolled into balls and coated in cocoa — an elegant, make-ahead chocolate.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 2 HOURS • BAKING SHEET (FOR CHILLING) • 24 TRUFFLES

- 10 oz (285g) semisweet chocolate, finely chopped
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 1/2 cup (45g) unsweetened cocoa powder, for coating

METHOD

1. Heat the cream until just simmering, pour over the chopped chocolate, and let sit 2 minutes.
2. Whisk in the butter until smooth, then chill the ganache at least 2 hours, until firm enough to scoop.
3. Scoop and roll into 1-inch balls, working quickly so they don't melt in your hands.
4. Roll each truffle in cocoa powder to coat.
5. Chill again briefly before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

Chocolate Peppermint Bark

Layered dark and white chocolate studded with crushed candy canes, broken into shards.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • BAKING SHEET • ABOUT 20 PIECES

- 12 oz (340g) semisweet chocolate, melted
- 12 oz (340g) white chocolate, melted
- 1/2 tsp peppermint extract
- 1/2 cup (85g) crushed candy canes

METHOD

1. Line a baking sheet with parchment. Stir the melted dark chocolate and spread it into an even layer. Chill 15 minutes, until just set.
2. Stir the peppermint extract into the melted white chocolate and pour over the set dark layer, spreading evenly.
3. Scatter the crushed candy canes over the top while the white chocolate is still wet.
4. Chill at least 1 hour, until fully set, then break into shards.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 3 weeks.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

No-Bake Rocky Road Clusters

Melted chocolate studded with marshmallows and nuts, set in the fridge rather than baked.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • BAKING SHEET • 16 CLUSTERS

- 12 oz (340g) semisweet chocolate, melted
- 1 1/2 cups (75g) mini marshmallows
- 1 cup (120g) chopped walnuts or almonds

METHOD

1. Line a baking sheet with parchment. Stir the marshmallows and nuts into the melted chocolate, working quickly before it sets.
2. Drop spoonfuls onto the lined sheet.
3. Chill at least 1 hour, until firm, before serving.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains dairy and tree nuts.

No-Bake Chocolate Coconut Bars

A dense coconut filling coated in chocolate, in the style of a classic coconut candy bar.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 2 HOURS • 9X9-INCH PAN • 16 BARS

COCONUT FILLING

- 3 cups (255g) shredded coconut
- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

COATING

- 12 oz (340g) semisweet chocolate, melted

METHOD

1. Mix the coconut filling ingredients together until evenly combined.
2. Press firmly into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
3. Chill 30 minutes, until firm, then cut into bars.
4. Dip each bar in melted chocolate, coating completely, and place on parchment to set.
5. Chill at least 1 hour, until the chocolate is firm.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

No-Bake Chocolate Peanut Butter Balls

A simple peanut butter and powdered sugar mixture rolled into balls and dipped in chocolate.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • BAKING SHEET • 24 BALLS

- 1 cup (260g) creamy peanut butter
- 1/4 cup (55g) unsalted butter, softened
- 2 cups (240g) powdered sugar
- 12 oz (340g) semisweet chocolate, melted

METHOD

1. Beat the peanut butter, butter, and powdered sugar together until a firm dough forms.
2. Roll into 1-inch balls and place on a parchment-lined sheet. Chill 20 minutes, until firm.
3. Dip each ball in melted chocolate, letting excess drip off, and return to the parchment.
4. Chill at least 1 hour, until the chocolate sets.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains dairy and peanuts.

PART 5

Fruit & Cream Desserts

Eight fruit-and-cream desserts, including trifle, fools, mousse, and panna cotta.

Classic Fruit and Cream Trifle

Layers of cake, pastry cream, and fresh fruit built in a glass bowl for a dramatic presentation.

PREP 30 MIN • CHILL 2 HOURS • LARGE TRIFLE BOWL OR GLASS DISH • 12 SERVINGS

- 1 store-bought or homemade pound cake, cubed
- 1 batch Pastry Cream Filling (see Decorating Handbook)
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, whipped with 2 tbsp powdered sugar
- 4 cups mixed fresh berries
- 2 tbsp fruit jam, warmed and thinned with 1 tsp water

METHOD

1. In a trifle bowl, layer a third of the cake cubes, a drizzle of thinned jam, a layer of pastry cream, and a layer of berries.
2. Repeat the layers twice more, finishing with a layer of whipped cream and a final scatter of berries on top.
3. Chill at least 2 hours before serving to let the layers settle.

Storage: Refrigerate; best within 2 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Fool (Whipped Cream and Fruit Puree)

A simple English dessert of fruit puree swirled through whipped cream — minimal effort, maximum flavor.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • 6 GLASSES • 6 SERVINGS

- 3 cups mixed berries (or stewed rhubarb)
- 1/3 cup (65g) granulated sugar
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, cold
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Cook the berries and granulated sugar over medium heat until softened, about 8 minutes, then puree or mash and cool completely.
2. Whip the cold cream and powdered sugar to soft peaks.
3. Swirl the cooled fruit puree through the whipped cream in broad strokes, leaving ribbons rather than fully blending.
4. Divide among glasses and chill at least 1 hour before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate; best within 1 day.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

No-Bake Strawberry Icebox Pie

A graham crust filled with a whipped cream cheese and fresh strawberry filling.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 9-INCH PIE PAN • 8 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (225g) strawberries, pureed
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, and strawberry puree until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the strawberry mixture.
4. Spread into the crust and chill at least 4 hours, until set.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Mango Mousse Cups

A light, airy mango mousse set with a small amount of gelatin.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 6 SMALL CUPS • 6 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (480g) mango puree (about 3 ripe mangoes, blended)
- 1/4 cup (60ml) cold water
- 2 tsp unflavored gelatin
- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, cold

METHOD

1. Sprinkle the gelatin over the cold water and let bloom 5 minutes.
2. Warm about 1/2 cup of the mango puree gently (do not boil), stir in the bloomed gelatin until fully dissolved, then stir this back into the remaining puree along with the sugar.
3. Whip the cold cream to soft peaks and fold into the mango mixture.
4. Divide among cups and chill at least 3 hours, until set.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

Classic Panna Cotta

A silky Italian cream dessert set with gelatin, simple and elegant, good topped with fruit or sauce.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 6 RAMEKINS OR GLASSES • 6 SERVINGS

- 2 1/2 cups (600ml) heavy cream
- 1/2 cup (120ml) whole milk
- 1/3 cup (65g) granulated sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 1/4 tsp (1 packet) unflavored gelatin
- 3 tbsp cold water

METHOD

1. Sprinkle the gelatin over the cold water and let bloom 5 minutes.
2. Warm the cream, milk, and sugar together until the sugar dissolves and the mixture is hot but not boiling.
3. Remove from heat, stir in the bloomed gelatin until fully dissolved, then stir in the vanilla.
4. Divide among ramekins or glasses and chill at least 4 hours, until set.
5. Serve as is, or unmold onto plates by briefly dipping each ramekin in warm water.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

Berry Panna Cotta Parfaits

The classic panna cotta layered in glasses with a berry compote for a built-in presentation.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 6 GLASSES • 6 SERVINGS

PANNA COTTA

- 2 1/2 cups (600ml) heavy cream
- 1/2 cup (120ml) whole milk
- 1/3 cup (65g) granulated sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 1/4 tsp (1 packet) unflavored gelatin
- 3 tbsp cold water

BERRY COMPOTE

- 2 cups (300g) mixed berries
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tsp fresh lemon juice

METHOD

1. Cook the compote ingredients over medium heat until the berries break down, about 8 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Make the panna cotta base as in the standard recipe.
3. Pour a layer of panna cotta into each glass and chill until just set, about 1 hour.
4. Top with a layer of cooled compote, then chill at least 3 more hours before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

Classic Chocolate Mousse

A light, airy chocolate dessert made with whipped cream rather than egg whites for a simpler, food-safe method.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 2 HOURS • 6 SMALL CUPS • 6 SERVINGS

- 8 oz (225g) semisweet chocolate, melted and cooled slightly
- 2 cups (480ml) heavy cream, cold
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Whip the cold cream, powdered sugar, and vanilla to soft peaks.
2. Fold about a third of the whipped cream into the cooled melted chocolate to lighten it, then fold in the rest in two additions, being careful not to deflate it.
3. Divide among cups and chill at least 2 hours, until set.
4. Top with a dollop of extra whipped cream before serving, if desired.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

Tropical Mango Coconut Parfaits

Layers of mango puree, coconut whipped cream, and granola for texture — no cooking required.

PREP 15 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • 6 GLASSES • 6 SERVINGS

- 2 cups (480g) mango puree (about 3 ripe mangoes, blended)
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar
- 1/2 cup (40g) shredded coconut, toasted
- 1 cup granola

METHOD

1. Whip the cold cream and powdered sugar to soft peaks, then fold in half the toasted coconut.
2. Layer the mango puree, coconut whipped cream, and granola in glasses, repeating until full.
3. Top with the remaining toasted coconut.
4. Chill at least 1 hour before serving so the granola softens slightly at the edges while staying crisp in the center.

Storage: Refrigerate; best within 1 day for the crispest granola.

Allergens: Contains dairy; granola may contain wheat and tree nuts.

PART 6

Chilled Pies & Individual Cups

Six more chilled pies and individual-portion desserts, including a food-safe no-bake French silk pie.

No-Bake Oreo Pie

A cookie crust filled with a whipped cream cheese filling studded with crushed sandwich cookies.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 9-INCH PIE PAN • 8 SLICES

CRUST

- 24 chocolate sandwich cookies, crushed (crumbs only)
- 4 tbsp (55g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold
- 12 chocolate sandwich cookies, roughly chopped

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese and powdered sugar until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, fold into the cream cheese mixture, then fold in the chopped cookies.
4. Spread into the crust and chill at least 4 hours, until set.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

No-Bake French Silk Pie

A silky, mousse-like chocolate filling in a cookie crust, using pasteurized eggs for food safety.

PREP 25 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 9-INCH PIE PAN • 8 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) chocolate cookie crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 4 oz (113g) unsweetened chocolate, melted and cooled
- 2 pasteurized eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, whipped to stiff peaks, for topping

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the butter and sugar until very light and fluffy, about 3 minutes, then beat in the cooled melted chocolate.
3. Add the pasteurized eggs one at a time, beating 3-5 minutes after each addition until the mixture is pale and airy — this long beating time is what gives the pie its silky texture.
4. Beat in the vanilla, then spread into the crust.
5. Chill at least 4 hours, until set, then top with whipped cream before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

No-Bake Peanut Butter Pie

A dense, rich peanut butter filling in a cookie crust, topped with a chocolate drizzle.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS • 9-INCH PIE PAN • 8 SLICES

CRUST

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 5 tbsp (70g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 cup (260g) creamy peanut butter
- 1 cup (120g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (360ml) heavy cream, cold

TOPPING

- 1/3 cup (55g) chocolate chips, melted, for drizzling

METHOD

1. Press the crust into the pan and chill.
2. Beat the cream cheese, peanut butter, and powdered sugar until smooth.
3. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, then fold into the peanut butter mixture.
4. Spread into the crust and chill at least 4 hours, until set.
5. Drizzle with melted chocolate before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and peanuts.

Lemon Icebox Cups

A layered individual dessert with graham crumbs, lemon filling, and whipped cream.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 6 SMALL CUPS • 6 SERVINGS

- 1 cup (100g) graham cracker crumbs
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter, melted
- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1/2 cup (120ml) fresh lemon juice
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, whipped to stiff peaks

METHOD

1. Mix the graham crumbs and melted butter, divide among the cups.
2. Whisk the condensed milk, lemon juice, and zest together until thickened.
3. Fold in half the whipped cream, then divide among the cups over the crumbs.
4. Top with the remaining whipped cream.
5. Chill at least 3 hours before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Individual Chocolate Chia Puddings

A simple chia-thickened chocolate pudding — set purely by soaking, no gelatin or dairy cooking needed.

PREP 10 MIN • CHILL 4 HOURS OR OVERNIGHT • 6 SMALL JARS • 6 SERVINGS

- 3 cups (720ml) whole milk
- 1/2 cup (85g) chia seeds
- 1/3 cup (30g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/4 cup (85g) honey or maple syrup
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Whisk the cocoa powder into the milk until no lumps remain.
2. Whisk in the chia seeds, honey, and vanilla.
3. Divide among the jars and whisk each one again after 10 minutes to prevent clumping.
4. Cover and chill at least 4 hours or overnight, until thickened to a pudding consistency.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains dairy.

No-Bake Cherry Icebox Cheesecake Cups

An individual-portion cheesecake cup topped with a classic cherry pie filling.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 3 HOURS • 6 SMALL CUPS • 6 SERVINGS

CRUMB LAYER

- 1 1/4 cups (125g) graham cracker crumbs
- 4 tbsp (55g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 16 oz (450g) cream cheese, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (240ml) heavy cream, cold

TOPPING

- 1 1/2 cups pitted cherries, fresh or jarred
- 1/4 cup granulated sugar
- 1 tsp cornstarch mixed with 1 tsp water

METHOD

1. Cook the cherry topping ingredients over medium heat until thickened, about 5 minutes. Cool completely.
2. Mix the crumbs and melted butter, divide among the cups.
3. Beat the cream cheese, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
4. Whip the cold cream to stiff peaks, fold into the cream cheese mixture, and pipe or spoon over the crumbs.
5. Chill at least 3 hours, then top with the cooled cherry topping just before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 3 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

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